AI-Generated Emotional Content Strategy for Niche Fashion Brands: Toward Identity-Based Visual Clustering

Minseok Yu, Eunjung Shin *†
Division of Global Fashion Industry, Hansung University, University, Korea

I. Introduction

❖ The Structural Limitation of Brand Content and the Necessity of Clustering

Structural Limitation of Niche Brand Content

Most niche brands currently operate under a *content production structure centered around their own SNS accounts*, and this **single-account, single-channel storytelling model severely limits initial exposure and amplification**, while **making content easily isolated and unable to deliver sufficient consumer immersion or sustained viral impact.**

Brands attempt to **communicate their own identity and emotional tone based on their individual accounts**, but this method **fundamentally lacks the ability to create narrative connections or synergy among brands.**

As a result, **brands are repeatedly exposed only within their own narrow networks and feeds**, ultimately **failing to build a sustainable expansion structure in the consumer experience.**

The Inability to Repeatedly Produce Emotion- and Symbol-Based Content (Resource Constraints)

Brands attempt to go beyond simple product exposure by **creating content that conveys emotional messages and symbolic stories**, but this process **demands significant time, cost, and creative resources**, including **story construction, emotional direction, and visual narrative design.**

Especially for small brands, there is no system that allows them to repeatedly and sustainably produce emotion- and symbol-driven content.

Consequently, most content is consumed as a one-time interaction, and the brand faces limitations in embedding itself deeply in consumers' memory

The Necessity of a Clustering Model as a Solution

This study proposes a **clustering-based brand expansion model** to solve these two structural limitations: **1. Isolation of content within SNS**, **2. The inability to repeatedly produce emotion- and symbol-driven content.**

This model **transcends isolated, brand-centric storytelling** and enables **meta-narrative expansion through emotional and symbolic resonance between brands.**

Brands are no longer isolated within their own accounts but are interconnected and expanded through a shared emotional and symbolic framework.

This allows consumers to **perceive brands not merely as individual products but as interconnected entities within an emotional universe**, driving **intuitive understanding, deep immersion, and repeated consumption.**

II. Theoretical Background

❖ The Possibility of Brand Expansion through Identity-Based Visual Clustering

The Possibility of Generative AI in Narrative Branding

Based on *De Freitas & Ofek (2024)'s argument* that **AI can maintain emotional consistency in brand management and automate symbolic storylines**, and *Karnatak et al. (2025)'s claim* that **AI can generate complex narratives and visual storytelling through structured prompting and multimodal interfaces**,

Generative AI holds strong potential as a tool to visualize the emotional narratives of niche brands and reinforce their identity through immersive storytelling.

How Symbolic and Narrative Structures Influence Brand Perception

Drawing from *Fournier & Alvarez (2024)'s argument* that **brand perception is shaped not by functional attributes but through cultural meaning and emotional narratives**, and *Kayacan (2023)'s emphasis* that **universal symbolic systems—such as myths, legends, and folktales—serve as core mechanisms for brand differentiation and emotional imprinting**,

It becomes clear that **brand perception is fundamentally based on symbolic and narrative structures rather than functional elements.**

This framework **prevents niche brands from being perceived as isolated entities**, instead allowing them to be **naturally interconnected and expanded as emotional and symbolic clusters within consumer cognition.**

The Structural Potential of Identity-Based Visual Clustering

By synthesizing the *symbolic meaning networks* identified in previous studies and the *narrative generation capabilities of Generative AI*, niche brands can expand into **meta-narrative clusters** similar to those seen in the **Marvel Cinematic Universe (MCU) and the DC Extended Universe (DCU).**

This identity-based visual clustering framework — a system that organizes brands into emotionally and symbolically interconnected clusters based on their design language, narrative tone, and visual identity coherence — enables niche brands to be **interconnected through emotional tones and symbolic narratives within a cohesive narrative world.**

It fosters **intuitive consumer understanding** and **immersive consumption** through **cross-brand symbolic resonance**, while **Generative AI technically supports this structure by clustering emotional tones and narrative-driven identities into mythological meta-structures**, enabling **scalable production of immersive, repeatable content.**

III. Solution Proposal

❖ Development of a Centralized Visual Identity Clustering System

Brand Identity and Narrative Framework Modeling

1. **Image Data Collection** — Collect branding assets from Instagram feeds, lookbooks, and campaign images
2. **AI-Driven Analysis and Narrative Formulation** — Analyze brand identity (signature color, emotional tone, mood, design language), seasonal narrative (theme, color scheme, slogan, symbolic objects), and product silhouettes through AI, transforming them into symbolic and emotional narratives
3. **Mythological & Symbolic Narrative Integration** — Directly connect the modeled identity and narrative framework to mythological motifs, folklore symbols, and archetypal narrative structures. This integration enhances emotional resonance and symbolic depth.
4. **Prompt Development** — Finalize prompts for AI image and video generation through human curation and refinement, based on the modeled identity framework combined with mythological and symbolic narratives.

Mythological Narrative and Scene Structure Design

1. **Motif Image Rendering** — Utilize the finalized prompts to generate motif images through **Midjourney**, visually expressing the brand's emotional tone, symbolic narrative, and seasonal identity integrated with mythological references.
2. **Video Production** — **T**ransform motif images, generated from the identity and narrative framework, into dynamic video content using **Midjourney Animate**, applying effects like texture transitions, fragmentation, and scene shifts to create both short-form scenes and full narrative cluster videos.
3. **Sound Design & Final Composition** — Develop customized soundscapes aligned with the emotional flow and symbolic narrative of each scene. This final stage integrates image, video, and sound into a cohesive, immersive narrative content output.

Identity Visual Narrative-Based Clustering Hub Architecture

- Content is clustered based on the brand's *design language*, *narrative tone*, and *visual identity coherence*. This structure is **not based on simple product categories** but on the **similarity of emotional and symbolic narratives.**
- As a result, brands establish a **repeatable and scalable content production system**, while consumers perceive the brand **not as an individual product but as a symbolic entity within a larger narrative universe.**
- This clustering structure leads to **practical strategic outcomes**, including **enhanced cross-brand exposure**, **amplified consumer immersion**, **increased repeat consumption**, **stronger brand memory**, **higher conversion rates**, and **sustainable content production.**

❖Example of Establishing a Narrative & Identity Framework for Clustering

Section	Core Identity Keywords	Mythological Position	Mythological Symbols	Cluster Characteristics
Intro / Outro	Absolute order, death, flow of boundaries	Underworld (Meta Space)	Temple, Forest, Rift	The meta narrative space where brands are clustered based on shared symbols of order, cycle, and boundaries. Functions as both the starting point and the return point of the narrative.
Rick Owens	Absolute darkness, order, architectural silhouette	Hades	Temple, Abyss	The cluster of order and structure. Visualized through temple structures, deep voids, monochrome aesthetics, and architectural minimalism.
Ann Demeulemeester	Melancholic romanticism, flow, duality	Persephone	Forest, Trees, Nature	The cluster of circulation and flow. Built upon organic, natural elements, fog, and the emotional tone of melancholy and duality.
Yohji Yamamoto	Funerary aesthetics, dissolution, flow	Melinoë	Rift	The cluster of dissolution and boundaries. Characterized by asymmetry, fragmentation.

❖ Mythological Narrative & Scene Structure Design

Image 1. Intro

Image 2. Rick Owens

Image 3. Ann Demeulemeester

Image 4. Yohji Yamamoto

Scene 0 (Intro)

Constructed from Rick Owens' **Temple structure**(Image 2), Ann Demeulemeester's **forest imagery**(Image 3), and Yohji Yamamoto's **vanishing point space**((Image 4), this meta space serves as the starting point for clustering within the shared symbolic framework of **order, cycle, and boundary.**

Image 5. Scene 1

Image 6. Scene 2

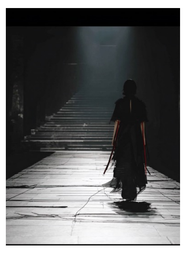
Image 7. Scene 3

Image 8. Scene Outro

Scene 1 — Rick Owens = Hades (Cluster of Absolute Order and Darkness)

Using the same **Temple structure** from Scene 0, Rick Owens is positioned as **Hades, the god of absolute order and darkness.** The **Temple represents structure and the abyss, while the deep blackness of Rick Owens mirrors the darkness and authority of the Underworld.** This scene becomes the **structural core of the meta space**, embodying **rigid order, depth, and the symbolism of death and dominance.**

Scene 2 — Ann Demeulemeester = Persephone (Cluster of the Dark Spring, Cycle, and Duality)

Using the same **Temple structure** from Scene 0, Rick Owens is positioned as **Hades, the god of absolute order and darkness.** The **Temple represents structure and the abyss, while the deep blackness of Rick Owens mirrors the darkness and authority of the Underworld.** This scene becomes the **structural core of the meta space**, embodying **rigid order, depth, and the symbolism of death and dominance.**

Scene 3 — Yohji Yamamoto = Melinoë (Cluster of Boundary, Dissolution, and Flow)

Using the vanishing point space from Yohji Yamamoto's official feed, this scene represents **Melinoë — the daughter of Hades and Persephone — a being that flows between existence and non-existence.** The spatial void and visual pathway symbolize **the boundary, dissolution, and the passage between presence and absence.** This cluster embodies the liminal flow of dissolution, fragmentation, and impermanence — the **space between the rigidity of order (Rick Owens)** and the **organic circulation of life and death (Ann Demeulemeester).**

Scene 4 — Outro (Return to Underworld)

By reassembling the symbols of **Temple, Forest, and Vanishing Point**, all clusters return to the **meta narrative space of the Underworld.** This signifies not an ending but a **cyclical return and reconfiguration**, where **order, cycle, and boundary continuously flow and restructure the narrative clustering system.**

❖ Expansion Strategy and Operational Model

Brand Recruitment and Hub Operation Strategy

- **Prioritize recruiting niche brands with clearly defined emotional and symbolic assets, operating under a shared promotional cost structure.**
- **The hub strengthens connections between brands through emotional and symbolic narratives, moving beyond isolated brand storytelling toward a collective narrative-driven expansion. This structure enables the hub to operate as a meta-world storytelling platform, where consumers perceive brands not as individual products but as emotionally interconnected clusters.**

Brand Communication Strategy

- **The symbolic narrative is presented as a strategic structure that helps brands leave a strong emotional impression and build deep consumer recall, while simultaneously enhancing conversion efficiency and achieving cost-effectiveness.**

Content Platform and Operational Strategy

- **Content is deployed and consumed primarily through visually immersive video strategies, centered on platforms optimized for emotional and visual storytelling such as Instagram, TikTok, and Pinterest.**

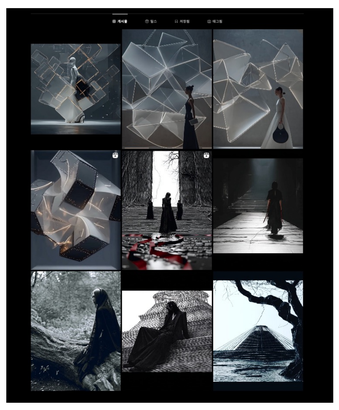
Image 9. Hub SNS

@AHEAYA_BARAYA
Image 10. Hub Link

IV. Conclusions

❖ Conclusions and Implications

From Isolated Feeds to Cluster Hub

This Clustering Hub offers a structural alternative to fragmented, feed-centered brand marketing by transforming brands into symbolic and emotionally interconnected narrative clusters. Through AI-driven automation, it enables the repeatable production of high-quality, symbolic, and immersive content at scale.

Category	Key Outcomes	Supporting Evidence / Rationale
Cost Reduction & Efficiency	85–90% reduction in content production and marketing costs	AI-driven production + shared brand campaign → distributed fixed costs. Compared to typical short-form production costs, at least 85% reduction achievable.
Emotional Imprinting Effect	Storage rate over 10%, repeat view rate over 15% consistently	Narrative-based emotional storytelling → Consumers are more likely to save or repeatedly engage with content.
Immersive Branding Effect	Stronger brand recall + deep emotional imprinting	Beyond simple product exposure → Story-driven, emotionally immersive brand experience that reinforces brand identity.
High Conversion Performance	Up to 1.8x higher conversion rate, click-through rate over 5%	Based on TikTok Creative Lab data. Content with high storage and repeat view rates shows at least 1.5–2x higher conversion compared to average.

V. References

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